



Book	Administrative Guideline Manual
Section	Administrative Guideline Updates
Title	Copy of TESTING PROGRAM
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2623A - TESTING PROGRAM

Purpose of Testing

Testing, like any other element of the District's operation, should have a definite purpose related to District programs or State mandates. No test should be given without first defining its purpose and determining how the results will be used.

SUGGESTED PURPOSES FOR VARIOUS TESTS

A. Diagnostic Assessments and Achievement Tests

1. measure a student's progress in achieving District learning outcomes
2. help determine student learning strengths and weaknesses and/or diagnose their causes
3. help assess the effectiveness of a grade level's, school's, or the District's program and/or identify/diagnose educational strengths and weaknesses
4. aid in evaluating curriculum and/or instructional strategies and resources
5. help determine the extent to which a student can perform tasks associated with literacy
6. aid in diagnosing problems with literacy skills and in providing for appropriate remediation
7. measure the skill in a specific content area
8. measure student comprehension of academic content standards and mastery of related skills for the relevant subject area at each grade, kindergarten through eighth

B. Intelligence Tests

measure a student's mental ability as defined by the tests

C. Readiness Tests

help determine the appropriate time for a student to begin a learning program

D. Vocations Interest/Aptitude Tests

1. help determine a student's interests or aptitudes for comparison with those related to particular vocational fields

2. assist in the vocational counseling of a student

Uses of Test Results

The purpose for giving a test is to use the results to improve learning and to communicate with those concerned about how well a student or group of students are learning.

Administration of Achievement Tests

To the extent required by law, the District shall administer the achievement tests for students in third, fourth, fifth, sixth, seventh, eighth and tenth grades in accordance with the schedule established by the State Department of Education and Workforce.

Item Analysis

If test results are to be used effectively, an analysis of the test items usually should be the first step. Such an analysis makes it easier to determine where students are strong and where the weaknesses are so that instruction can be geared accordingly. A proper analysis should provide the kind of knowledge that will not only aid in designing appropriate learning activities but in producing a more reliable assessment.

Disaggregation of Results

The second step for the effective use of test results would be the disaggregation of scores based upon specific criteria determined by the District. Analyzing scores in this way makes it possible to determine if certain groups of students demonstrate particular academic strengths or weaknesses. Such analysis will aid in designing appropriate learning activities or intervention strategies.

Curriculum and Instruction

Administrators will be responsible for instructing staff in how to use test results to both refine the curriculum and improve instructional strategies and resources. To aid in this process, staff meetings, team meetings, department meetings and in-service programs may be necessary to strengthen understanding of how different kinds of tests are designed, how to judge reliability and validity, and how to use test information to diagnose and remediate.

Counseling

Administrators should ensure that teachers and counselors are working cooperatively by sharing information derived from the testing program. The counselors may be using test results and analyses to help students (and their parents) develop a realistic and valid view of their current achievement levels and design and follow through on plans related to both their school and vocational careers. Teachers should also be aware of these plans to help support such plans in the classroom.

Communication with Parents

As one of the important partners in the educative process, it is essential that parents be kept properly informed of standardized test results, particularly those that relate directly to academic achievement. Results will be released by June 30 each year and will be sent via mail or email or, alternatively, will be posted to a secure portal that families can access on the District's or school's website. ~~In communicating with parents, particularly with regard to standardized tests, test results should be provided in context, that is, with the purpose of the test(s) clearly stated and the student's measurement compared to standards.~~ In communicating with parents, particularly with regard to standardized tests, the following guidelines should be observed:

- A. Test results should be provided in context, that is, with the purpose of the test(s) clearly stated and the student's measurement compared to standards.
- B. Make sure parents are aware of the relationship between the test's purpose and the goals of the particular program of which the test is a part.
- C. Communicate what the test is designed to measure as well as what it does not attempt to measure.
- D. Share the norms, if applicable, and how such norms or standards have been created.
- E. Seek questions, provide or obtain reliable answers, and, if the parent is not satisfied with the answer(s), refer the question to the next level of authority.

Use in Remediation and Promotion/Retention (see Form 2623A F1)

- A. Intervention services shall be provided to students who score below the basic range on an achievement test.
- B. Test results will be used by all classroom teachers to identify and implement instruction appropriate to the needs of students.
- C. Test results may be used by administrators and/or guidance personnel in making instructional placement decisions regarding particular students, except that unless expressly authorized by State law, a student's failure to attain a specified score on any state-mandated, statewide assessment test shall not serve as a factor in any decision to deny the student promotion to a higher grade level.
- D. Intervention shall continue until students attain a score at or above the basic range on an achievement test.
- E. Special area teachers shall assist regular classroom teachers in the identification of individual student needs and in accommodating instruction to the intervention needs of identified students.
- F. Textbooks and other instructional materials appropriate to the intervention needs of students should be identified and correlated to the adopted courses of study and to the Ohio Academic Content Standards.